of stool is removed with a stick or spatula and is placed in the container. Discard the stick in the waste bin.

9.2 Collecting stool specimen for routine examination

DEFINITION

Collection of a small quantity of stool sample in a container for testing in the laboratory.

PURPOSE

To test the stool for normal and presence of abnormalities.

ARTICLES

1. A Clean specimen container.
2. A spatula for putting the specimen into the container.
3. Dry bed-pan (for helpless patients). Additional bedpan for rinsing and cleaning.
4. Laboratory requisition form.
5. Clean gloves.
6. Waste paper (for wrapping used spatula).
7. A pitcher of water (for helpless patient).
8. Tissues / towel.

PROCEDURE

	Nursing action	Rationale
1	Check the physician's order and 'Nursing Care Plan'.	Obtains specific instruction and information
2	Identify the patient.	Helps to perform the right procedure for the right patient.
3	Explain to patient the procedure and make clear what is expected of him/her.	Aids in proper collection of specimen.
4	Give the labeled container and spatula to the patient with instructions. ie. To defecate into clean dry bedpan. Not to contaminate specimen with urine.	
5	Done gloves	
6	For helpless patient assist patient on to the clean bedpan	
7	Leave him with instructions	
8	When done, remove and keep aside the bedpan after placing the second one for cleansing.	

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